KoiKoi | The Party Pass

Product Design Assignment

1. Design rationale

The Party Pass is a game-powered digital invitation that transforms an ordinary invite into a small, interactive experience. Instead of receiving a message with event details, guests receive a personalised link where they play a mini-game to unlock their invitation.

The idea came from a simple observation: invitations are often treated as a formality. People share the date, time, and venue, but the experience rarely builds anticipation for the event itself. I wanted to explore how an invitation could become a reflection of the host's personality while giving guests a reason to engage before the party even begins.

The experience is designed around two equally important users. The host needs a simple way to create and personalise an invitation, while the guest should be able to enjoy the experience without feeling that it takes too much time or effort. The mini-games add an element of surprise, the music adds a personal touch, and the invitation reveal keeps the event details and RSVP action easy to find.

My goal was to make the invitation feel like the beginning of the celebration, rather than just a message announcing it.

2. Understanding the user

Target users

The primary users are people organising birthdays, house parties, dinners, and other informal social gatherings, along with friends and guests receiving those invitations.

- Hosts: Want a personalised, memorable way to invite people without spending too much time designing invitations.
- Guests: Want to understand the event details quickly while enjoying something fun and different from a standard invitation.
- Socially expressive users: Enjoy personalising experiences through music, visual themes, games, and shared memories.

User insight

An invitation has two jobs: communicate practical information and build excitement. Traditional digital invitations usually focus on the first, leaving little room for anticipation or personal expression.

The opportunity was to bring both together through a simple, playful experience that feels personal without making the process of creating or accepting an invitation complicated.

Design challenge

How might we turn a digital party invitation into an interactive, personalised experience that builds anticipation while keeping the creation process simple and the event information accessible?

3. The concept: The Party Pass

The Party Pass allows a host to create a personalised invitation, select a mini-game, add a song, and share a unique link with guests. Guests open the link, play the selected game, and unlock the invitation with the event details and RSVP option.

The experience includes three mini-games:

1. Crossword

Guests solve a crossword to reveal the invitation. This introduces a word-based challenge that can be connected to the host, the occasion, or shared references.

2. Puzzle

Guests assemble the puzzle to unlock the invitation. The interaction turns the reveal into a small, hands-on activity.

3. Crack the Code

Guests solve a code-based challenge to unlock their invitation. The mechanic adds suspense and makes the reveal feel like discovering a secret.

The host chooses the game that best suits the occasion and the kind of experience they want guests to have.

4. Experience flow

Host journey

01

Start creating: The host begins creating a new Party Pass.

02

Personalise the invitation: They enter the host and guest names, choose the party type and vibe, and add the date, time, and venue.

03

Choose a mini-game: They select one of the three experiences: Crossword, Puzzle, or Crack the Code.

04

Add a soundtrack: They can add a song to give the invitation a more personal feel, including selecting a specific section of the track.

05

Preview and share: They review the invitation experience and generate a unique link to share with guests.

Guest journey

01

Open the link: The guest lands on a personalised invitation experience.

02

Play the game: They complete the crossword, assemble the puzzle, or crack the code.

03

Unlock the invitation: A reveal moment introduces the event details.

04

Experience the soundtrack: If the host added a song, the guest can listen to the selected section.

05

Respond to the invite: The guest reviews the date, time, and venue, then responds through the RSVP action.

Copywriting decisions

The copy is intended to sound conversational, playful, and personal rather than formal. The language builds curiosity before the invitation is revealed, while the practical information remains direct and easy to understand.

Examples of the copy direction include:

- Creation: “Let's make this invite a little more interesting.”
- Game introduction: “Your invite is waiting. Ready to unlock it?”
- Puzzle or code interaction: “You're getting closer!”
- Invitation reveal: “You've unlocked your Party Pass!”
- RSVP: “Count me in!” and “Can't make it this time.”

These are examples of the intended tone and can be adjusted to match the final interface.

5. Visual design decisions

The visual direction combines an editorial layout with a playful scrapbook aesthetic. I wanted the experience to feel celebratory without becoming visually cluttered or relying on generic party graphics.

Element	Design decision	Rationale
Typography	Bold editorial serif headlines paired with clean sans-serif body text	Creates personality while keeping instructions readable and the interface easy to navigate.
Colour palette	Warm cream, deep ink, and signature pink	Balances warmth with a distinctive visual identity and makes important actions stand out.
Decorative imagery	Disco balls, tickets, ribbons, and subtle party details	Establishes a celebratory scrapbook aesthetic without relying on generic party graphics.
Form layout	Large, centred form card with generous spacing	Keeps the creation process as the primary focus and makes fields easier to scan.
Background	Minimal decorative elements with a subtle dark overlay behind the form	Creates depth while drawing attention towards the form rather than the surrounding visuals.

Interactions	Selectable cards, game mechanics, song controls, and reveal animations	Makes the experience engaging while providing clear feedback for user actions.
Copywriting	Short, conversational messages that evolve throughout the journey	Builds curiosity, encourages participation, and makes the invitation feel personal.
Mobile layout	Stacked content, touch-friendly controls, and reduced decoration	Ensures the experience remains usable and visually clear on smaller screens.

The form remains the visual centre of the creation experience. Decorative elements support the concept but do not compete with the primary task. I also avoided handwriting-style fonts to preserve readability and maintain the editorial direction.

The mobile-first approach prioritises clear hierarchy, comfortable spacing, readable text, and touch-friendly controls. Since guests may open their invitations through messaging apps, the experience should work smoothly on smaller screens without requiring unnecessary navigation.

6. AI usage and design process

I used AI as a tool to explore possibilities and accelerate execution, while keeping the core concept, visual direction, and product decisions grounded in my own judgement.

ChatGPT helped me brainstorm ideas, develop the initial concept, and explore different design possibilities. I used it to think through ways of making a digital invitation more interactive and to explore how games and music could become part of the experience.

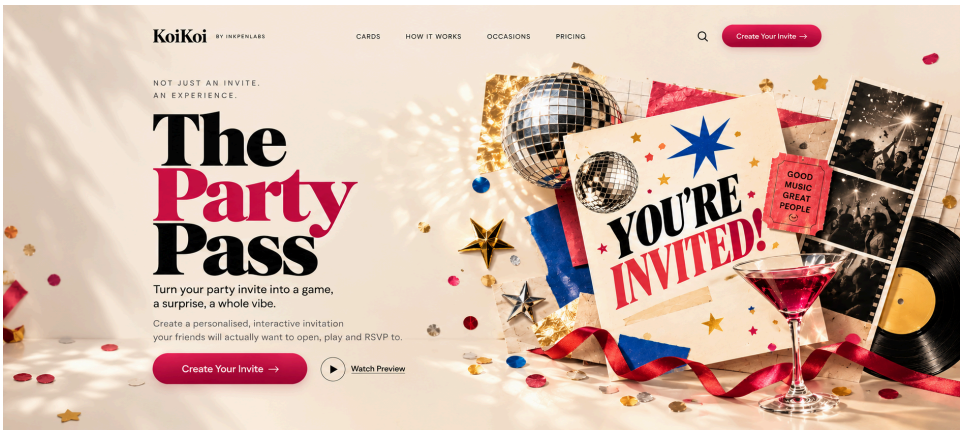
Claude Code supported the development process and helped translate the concept into a working experience.

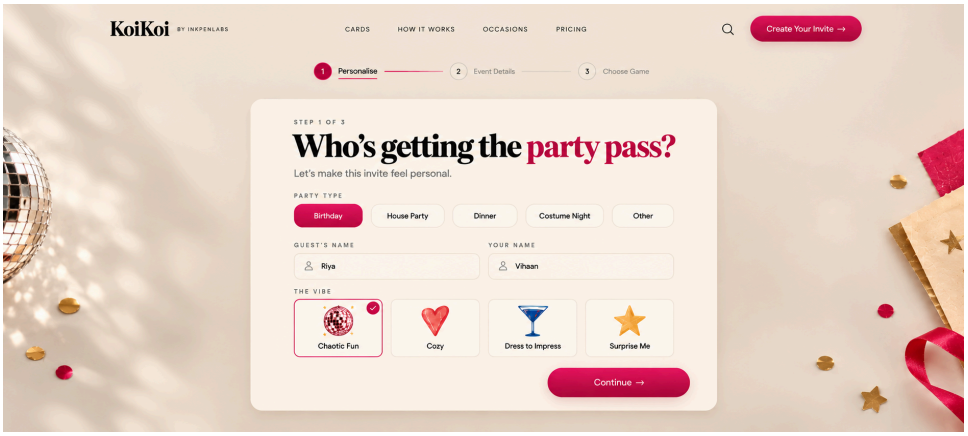
I created the moodboard, selected the colour palette, established the visual direction, and decided the overall user flow myself. The three game concepts, the soundtrack feature, and the direction of the user experience were also guided by my own ideas. AI was used to help explore and execute these decisions rather than replace the design thinking behind them.

The process was iterative: I explored options, assessed them against the intended experience, and refined the product where the interactions did not meet user needs.

The Moodboard and Designs I created:







7. User testing and iterations

I tested the experience with two users to understand how the interactions felt in practice and identify areas where the original design created friction.

Feedback 1: Song selection

What I observed: The initial song-selection experience did not fully meet users' expectations because they could not choose a specific song.

What I changed: I added the ability to Search for a particular track, making the soundtrack feature more personal and giving hosts greater control over the moment they wanted to share. The recommendation system works through Apple Music and if it isn’t available, they can add a Spotify song link.

Why it mattered: Music was intended to be an expression of the host's personality. Allowing users to select a Song better supported that purpose than simply attaching any random song.

Feedback 2: Puzzle interaction

What I observed: The original puzzle mechanic involved swapping pieces that were already positioned on the board. Users found this slow and time-consuming.

What I changed: I redesigned the interaction so that the puzzle pieces appear in a separate tray and can be dragged and dropped onto the board.

Why it mattered: The revised interaction makes the task more direct and gives users a clearer understanding of where pieces belong. It also reduces the friction of repeatedly swapping pieces on the board.

What I learned

The testing reinforced that a playful concept still needs to respect users' time. An interaction can look engaging in a design but feel frustrating when someone actually uses it.

I used the feedback to improve two specific parts of the experience rather than adding more features. With only two users tested, these changes are an initial iteration rather than proof that every usability issue has been resolved. Further testing would help validate the revised puzzle mechanic and song-selection flow.

8. Final summary

What user insight informed your design?

Digital invitations often communicate the essential details but do little to build excitement or reflect the host's personality. I wanted to turn the invitation into an experience that guests could participate in, rather than something they simply read.

What concept did you create, and why?

I created The Party Pass, a game-powered digital invitation that combines personalisation, mini-games, music, and an invitation reveal. The concept makes the act of receiving an invitation more memorable while keeping the event information and RSVP accessible.

How did your design decisions support the experience?

The structured creation flow keeps the host's task manageable, while the three game options offer different ways to engage guests. The soundtrack feature adds personal expression, and the editorial scrapbook visual direction creates a distinct celebratory identity. Clear typography, a focused form layout, and a mobile-first structure help keep the experience usable.

How did you use AI?

I used ChatGPT for ideation and exploring design possibilities, and Claude Code to support development. I made the core product decisions, created the moodboard, selected the palette, and established the flow. AI helped me develop and execute the idea, while the final direction remained guided by my design judgement.

What did user testing teach you?

Testing with two users revealed friction in the song-selection and puzzle interactions. I responded by adding specific song selection and redesigning the puzzle around a tray with drag-and-drop placement. These iterations helped make the experience more personal and less time-consuming, while highlighting the value of testing interactions with real users before considering a finished design.